A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE

MBBS, PhD, FRACP

Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist

PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

27 May 2026

Dr Basit Khan
Shepparton GP Medical Practice And Acupuncture Clinic

Dear Dr Khan,

Re: Mr Samuel Marland
DOB: 21/07/2006 Phone: 0427 622 661
Address: 730 McEwen Rd, KYVALLEY, VIC, 3621
Email: cdmarlo@bigpond.com

Summary

- **Improving Crohn's disease with significant reduction in abdominal pain and gastrointestinal symptoms.**
- **Maintaining Stelara (ustekinumab) at the current 8-weekly interval.**
- **Neuromodulator therapy and dose escalation of Stelara deferred given clinical response.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of reviewing Samuel. He is currently feeling significantly better, with a notable improvement in his energy levels and a marked reduction in his abdominal pain.

Interestingly, despite our previous discussion about increasing the frequency of his Stelara to every four weeks and commencing a neuromodulator for pain, Sam has remained on the 8-weekly interval and did not start the new medication. Despite this, he reports his bowel frequency has normalised to three solid movements per day without any blood or mucus. He did mention a one-month period of "floaty" stools which has since resolved. I suspect this may have been related to transient fat malabsorption or perhaps a period of small intestinal bacterial overgrowth, but as it has settled and his weight is stable, I do not believe any specific intervention such as antibiotics is required at this stage.

We discussed his use of a specific mineral water; while he feels this has contributed to his improvement, I suspect it may be that the Stelara has now reached full therapeutic effect. I have also noted that his fatigue, while still present, is approximately 50% better than when we first met.

Impression and Plan Samuel is currently in a very good position clinically. Given the resolution of his pain, I no longer see a clear indication for the nerve medication we had previously considered. We will continue with Stelara at the current 8-weekly interval rather than escalating to 4-weekly.

I have requested that he undergo interval blood tests now, and I have provided him with a pathology request for further bloods and a faecal calprotectin to be performed in six months. I will review him again in six months' time to satisfy PBS requirements and ensure his symptoms remain well-controlled.

Yours sincerely,

All appointments and enquires

Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations

Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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CC: Ms Helen Aharfi, Dr Peter Holsman

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